The information relating to Home Minister Narasimha Rao being asked to transfer control of Delhi Police to 1 Akbar Road was confirmed by Ambassador K.C. Singh (Retd) as well as journalist and academic Vinay Sitapati, author of *Half Lion: How PV Narsimha Rao Transformed India* (Viking 2016). In his interview by *In Focus* magazine of the *Economic Times* , in its issue of 26 June–2 July 2016, Sitapati made an interesting revelation in response to a question as to why he had described 1984 as the 'vilest hour' of Narasimha Rao in his book. This is quoted below:

> In the 1984 Sikh riots, the Delhi Police was reporting to Rao, the home minister. As I point out, he got a phone call in the evening of October 31 from someone very close to Rajiv Gandhi in the PMO that violence against Sikhs was likely and that there was a need for coordinated response and the PMO was going to take all the policing functioning into its hands. Rao could have disobeyed the orders and protected the Sikhs – he would have lost his job, but that would have been the honorable thing to do. When it came to choosing between protecting the lives of 2,733 Sikhs and listening to the Congress, he chose to listen the Congress. Every other Congressman did that but he was the only Congressman who was also the home minister of India. Morally that was his lowest point. [3]

That Rao's police powers had been fully usurped by 1 Akbar Road was further corroborated during a recent conversation I had with Ambassador K.C. Singh (Retd). He was posted as deputy secretary at the president's office at Rashtrapati Bhavan during those fateful days. K.C. narrated how, on the morning of 1 November, upon seeing smoke emanating from some buildings in the nearby markets and residential areas, Zail Singh had called Home Minister Narasimha Rao to check what was happening in the city. There was no response from Rao.

Later in the evening, Rao called Zail Singh back. However, instead of updating the president on developments in the city, Narasimha Rao surprised Zail Singh by seeking the latter's